MediScript

The plain-English Editing Guide

How to change anything in your project by hand — which file to open, what to change, and how to not break it. No prior knowledge of the code assumed.

NOTE You never need to understand the whole codebase to make a change. Find your goal in the **Common Edits** section, open the one file it names, change the text, save, refresh. That's it.

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1 · The big picture — how the app is organised

MediScript is a website with two 'portals': one for **patients (User)** and one for **pharmacies (Chemist)**. Everything lives in one project folder. There are really only three kinds of files you'll ever touch:

This kind of file...	...controls...	...and lives in
HTML templates	The **pages** — the words, buttons and layout you see on screen.	app/templates/
Stylesheet (CSS)	The **look** — colours, fonts, spacing, rounded corners.	app/static/css/style.css
Python code	The **logic** — reading prescriptions, matching medicines, saving data.	app/services/ & app/api/

TIP 90% of the changes you'll want (text, colours, menus, page layout) are in the first two rows — templates and one CSS file. You rarely need to touch Python.

2 · Project map — what every folder does

Here is the whole project in plain English. You can safely ignore anything not listed as 'edit this'.

Folder / file	What it is	Edit it?
app/templates/	All the web pages (HTML). The folder you'll use most.	YES
app/templates/base.html	The shared frame every page sits inside (header, nav slot).	sometimes

Folder / file	What it is	Edit it?
app/templates/landing.html	The public home page (hero + portal cards).	YES
app/templates/user/	Patient pages: dashboard, upload, search, analytics, trends, settings.	YES
app/templates/chemist/	Pharmacy pages: dashboard, dispense, inventory, demand, analytics, news.	YES
app/templates/*/_nav.html	The top menu bar for each portal.	YES
app/static/css/style.css	All colours, fonts and styling for the whole app.	YES
app/static/js/app.js	Shared browser helpers (form handling, buttons).	rarely
app/services/	The 'brains': OCR, medicine matching, prices, news, analytics.	advanced
app/api/	The web addresses (URLs) the pages call to get data.	advanced
app/models/	The database shape (what a user / prescription / item stores).	advanced
data/	The medicine datasets (names, compositions, prices). Ships ready to use.	no
scripts/	One-off helpers (build the medicine DB, deploy, enable AI model).	no
app/core/config.py	Settings & tuning knobs (thresholds, keys, model on/off).	YES
.env	Your private settings (OCR key). You create this; never shared publicly.	YES
render.yaml / DEPLOY.md	How the app deploys to Render's free tier.	read

3 · Where does my change go? (the 60-second rule)

Ask yourself what you're changing, then open the matching file:

I want to change...	Open this
The words/buttons on a page	the matching file in app/templates/ (e.g. user/search.html)
Colours, fonts, spacing	app/static/css/style.css
The menu items	app/templates/user/_nav.html or chemist/_nav.html
The header/logo shared by all pages	app/templates/base.html
How strict medicine matching is	app/core/config.py (thresholds)
The free-demo limits	app/api/guest_api.py
The news sources	app/services/news_service.py
What info a medicine shows	app/services/medicine_info.py
Your OCR key / settings	.env

NOTE

Templates use small placeholders like `{% block content %}` and `{{ user.name }}`. Leave those alone and just edit the plain text around them — they fill in automatically.

4 · Common edits (copy-paste recipes)

#1 **Change the app's colours / theme**

File: `app/static/css/style.css`
Near the top you'll see colour variables. Change the value after the colon and every page updates. Main ones: `--pen` (main teal), `--mint`, `--amber`, `--coral`.

```
/* app/static/css/style.css  */
:root{
  --pen:  #0E5C63;   /* main brand colour  -> change this */
  --mint: #3FA786;   /* success / good     */
  --amber:#B4691F;   /* warnings           */
  --coral:#C4453C;   /* errors / danger    */
}
```

#2 **Edit text, a headline, or a button label**

File: `the page's file in app/templates/`
Open the page (e.g. the search page is `user/search.html`), find the text between the tags, and type your new text. Don't remove the < > tags themselves.

```
<!-- before -->
<h1>Read a prescription</h1>

<!-- after -->
<h1>Scan your doctor's note</h1>
```

#3 **Add, rename, or remove a menu item**

File: `app/templates/user/_nav.html (or chemist/_nav.html)`
Each menu link is one line. Copy a line to add an item; edit the text to rename; delete the line to remove it. The part in quotes after href is the address it opens.

```
<a href="/app/search" class="{{ 'active' if active=='search' }}">Search</a>
```

#4 **Change the home (landing) page**

File: `app/templates/landing.html`
This is the first page visitors see. The big headline is in the `<section class="hero">` block; the two portal boxes and the feature cards are below it. Edit the text like any other page.

#5 **Make medicine matching stricter or looser**

File: `app/core/config.py`
`match_threshold` is the score (0-100) a medicine must beat to be shown. Higher = fewer but safer matches; lower = more matches but more false ones. Default 72.

```
# app/core/config.py
match_threshold: int = 72   # raise to 78 for stricter, lower to 65 for looser
```

#6 **Change how many free tries the demo gives**

File: `app/api/guest_api.py`
Near the top: `FREE_UPLOADS` and `FREE_SEARCHES`. Set them to whatever you like.

```
FREE_UPLOADS  = 1   # free prescription reads before sign-in
FREE_SEARCHES = 1   # free medicine searches before sign-in
```

#7 Change the health-news sources

File: `app/services/news_service.py`
The lists `_DEFAULT_HEALTH` (for patients) and `_DEFAULT_PHARMA` (for chemists) hold the RSS feed web addresses. Add or remove URLs. Only use trustworthy sources.

#8 Set or change your OCR key

File: `.env (a file you create in the project root)`
Get a free key at ocr.space, then put it in a file named `.env`. Restart the app after changing it.

```
OCRSPACE_KEYS=your_key_here
# multiple keys? separate with commas:
# OCRSPACE_KEYS=key1,key2
```

#9 Add your own medicine data

File: `data/datasets/ (drop-in folder)`
Put a CSV or TXT of medicine names into `data/datasets/`, then run `python scripts/build_medicine_db.py`. It gets merged into the search automatically.

#10 Turn on the optional AI medicine-name model

File: `.env (plus a one-time install)`
Run `scripts/enable_med7.sh` (or .ps1 on Windows), then add the two lines below to .env. Leave them out to keep the fast built-in detector.

```
DRUG_NER_MODEL=en_core_med7_lg
DRUG_NER_LABELS=DRUG
```

5 · Running the app on your computer

Do this once to set up:

```
python -m venv .venv
# Windows:
.venv\Scripts\activate
# Mac/Linux:
source .venv/bin/activate

pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Then every time you want to run it:

```
uvicorn app.main:app --reload
# now open http://127.0.0.1:8000 in your browser
```

TIP The `--reload` flag means page edits appear as soon as you refresh the browser. For CSS/JS changes, do a hard refresh (Ctrl+F5) to beat the cache.

CAUTION First start takes a few seconds — it loads a large medicine list into memory. That's normal.

6 · Putting it online (Render, free)

Full steps are in **DEPLOY.md**. In short:

Step	What to do
1	Push the project to a GitHub repository.
2	On render.com: New + -> Blueprint -> pick your repo.
3	When asked, paste your OCR.space key into OCRSPACE_KEYS.
4	Click Apply. After a few minutes it's live at your-name.onrender.com.

NOTE The free tier sleeps when idle, so the first visit after a break can take 10-30 seconds to wake up. It also resets stored data on redeploy — fine for a demo. DEPLOY.md shows how to add a database if you want data to persist.

7 · Safety net — how to not break things (and undo)

Habit	Why
Change one thing, then refresh	If something breaks you know exactly what caused it.
Keep a copy before big edits	Copy the file (e.g. search.html -> search.backup.html) first.
Use Git	Run 'git status' to see changes and 'git checkout -- file' to undo a file.
Run the tests	'python -m pytest' checks the app still works after code changes.
Don't edit inside {{ }} or {% %}	Those are placeholders the app fills in; changing them can error.

DON'T Avoid editing files in `data/`, `app/models/` or `migrations/` unless you know what you're doing — those touch the database and the medicine sources.

8 · One-page cheat sheet

I want to change...	Open this file
Colours / fonts / spacing	app/static/css/style.css
Text on the User search page	app/templates/user/search.html
Text on the Upload page	app/templates/user/upload.html

I want to change...	Open this file
Text on the Chemist inventory page	app/templates/chemist/inventory.html
The home page	app/templates/landing.html
The header/logo (all pages)	app/templates/base.html
The menus	app/templates/user/_nav.html, chemist/_nav.html
Matching strictness	app/core/config.py (match_threshold)
Free demo limits	app/api/guest_api.py
News feeds	app/services/news_service.py
Medicine info shown	app/services/medicine_info.py
Prices / savings logic	app/services/medicine_details.py
Which lines count as medicines	app/services/drug_ner.py
Your OCR key & settings	.env

9 · Mini-glossary (words you'll see)

Word	Plain meaning
Template	An HTML file that becomes a web page.
Jinja block ({% ... %})	A placeholder in a template the app fills in. Leave it as-is.
CSS	The stylesheet that decides how things look.
Variable (--pen)	A named colour/value reused across the CSS. Change once, applies everywhere.
Endpoint / API	A web address a page calls to fetch or save data (in app/api/).
Service	A Python file that does one job (OCR, matching, news) in app/services/.
Model	The database definition of a thing (user, prescription) in app/models/.
OCR	Turning a photo of text into computer text (here, OCR.space).
NER	Spotting which words are medicines before matching them.
.env	A private file holding your keys/settings, kept out of GitHub.
uvicorn	The command that runs the app locally.

MediScript editing guide · keep this next to you while you tinker. When in doubt, change text (safe), not the tags or placeholders around it.